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Trust to help persons with mental disabilities

Special Correspondent

Parents of mentally challenged children can hope for support for their wards from a number of schemes operated by the National Trust, an autonomous organisation under the Union Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, president of Asha Deep P.M.K. Rao said.

The trust established under the "National Trust for the Welfare of Persons with Autism, Cerebral Palsy, Mental Retardation and Multiple Disabilities" Act 1999, offers a medical insurance scheme that has been designed specifically for the mentally challenged.

The trust also offers support like scholarship for students and funding for those looking at setting up micro enterprises, he told mediapersons here on Tuesday.

Persons with mental disabilities require guardians even after they attain legal majority at 18 years of age. They continue to depend on others for seeking concessions, loans and managing investments, among others. A parent or a relative seeking to get legal recognition as a guardian needs to apply to the Local Level Committee (LLC).

The LLC is empowered to appoint, monitor and remove a guardian if necessary.

City based civil society organisation the Ability People (TAP) working with disabled persons in and around Visakhapatnam has been appointed statutory member of the LLC by the National Trust, TAP director Dilip Patro announced. For details contact P.M.K. Rao at 9393100057 or call TAP toll free helpline – 1800 425 8911.

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